

Hello.

I'm a UX research leader driving user-centered innovation for high-growth companies and complex systems.



CAROL BALES

USER RESEARCH

Alignment with Sr. UX Research Role



Proven UX Research & Design Leader

15+ years in research and 20+ years in UX design across SaaS, B2C, B2B, enterprise. Deep experience with qualitative and quantitative research methodologies.



Research Operations and Team Manager

Led high-volume mixed-methods team and managed research operations; insights informed 400M users.



Clear, Action-Oriented Storyteller

Translate complex findings into actionable insights for leaders & teams, championing the voice of the consumer.



Embracing Innovation

MS in HCI (Georgia Tech) with focus on creative processes; teach Human-Computer Interaction at GSU. Comfortable with the ambiguity of innovating with emerging tech.



Trusted Strategic Partner

Recognized thought leader at TWC; aligned ELT, stakeholders and product teams on strategy, bringing clarity and focus.

Career Impact Snapshot



400M+

users



Research insights informed critical product decisions across IBM/The Weather Company's global audience.

37%

efficiency gain



Improved subscription purchase flow using iterative usability testing.

+26%

NPS growth



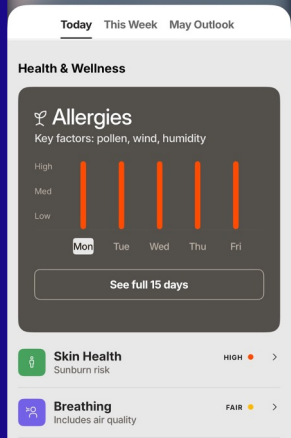
Enhanced newsletter engagement through quarterly metrics research.

Design Research Project Highlights



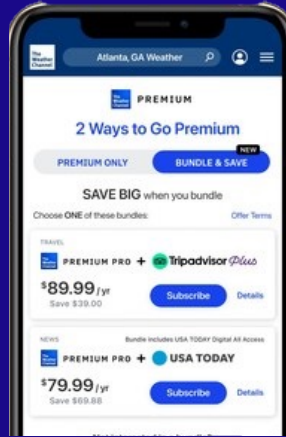
Driving product growth and user engagement through actionable research.

Mixed-method research to identify unmet needs



Qual and quant research into well-being and weather lead to new features and content in app redesign

RITE Method to increase purchase completion



Iterative testing cleared blockers in the purchase scenario and improved usability improved by 37%

Research to predict likelihood to subscribe



Novel features and content were evaluated for popularity and potential lift to subscriber audience. The high scorer launched as a premium offering

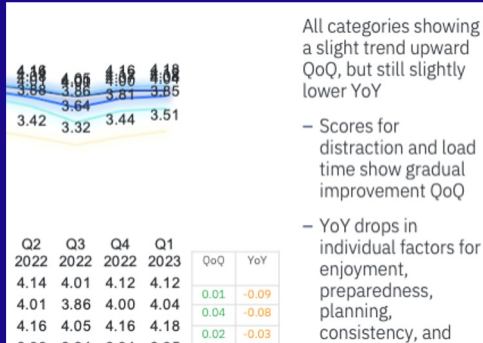
Leadership & Strategy Highlights



Recognized impact as a thought leader and highly productive practitioner.

Strengthened research practice.

Scaled research influence across the org by launching a monthly research showcase, a quarterly UX benchmark program, and a centralized research repository — bringing new business areas and stakeholders into the fold.



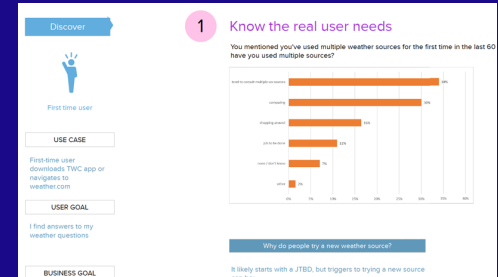
Agile Design, Rooted in Research

Built a Jobs-to-be-Done storytelling framework in Mural that empowered teams to write user stories reflecting both consumer product and ad sales perspectives — aligning priorities across silos.



Customer Journey, Grounded in Evidence

Partnered with Product and Marketing to create a research-backed customer journey map that captured user goals, churn drivers, and weather-related jobs-to-be-done — directly shaping retention and acquisition strategies.



More Career Highlights



#1 Prototyped a decision-support tool to optimize the community selection and move-in processes. Research confirmed that **attrition dropped** and **satisfaction increased** during the sales process. Brookdale Senior Living (by StellarX)

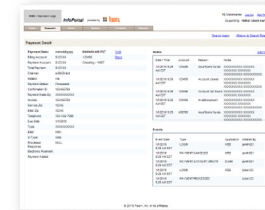
#2 At Fiserv, I **improved the findability of key information by 70%** in their bill-pay call-center application.

#3 Through A/B split-testing, I **optimized the hotel search and booking process**, resulting in significant increases in revenue for InterContinental Hotels Group.



Participants were shown 3 views of a payment detail

2. Navigate to a separate page



Several participants initially preferred this view to #1 for clarity and lack of busy-ness.

When prompted to consider that the advantages / disadvantages of navigating away from the search results, participants then preferred either #1 or #3

Proven impact across Fortune 500s & high growth innovators





Guiding Principles

Understanding the need drives better business outcomes

Open transparent communications = happy stakeholders and teams

Don't let perfect be the enemy of progress

Leadership sets the north star, then removes obstacles from the path



Thank you.

cjbales@gmail.com

770-855-5858

www.carolbales.com

www.linkedin.com/in/carolbales/